

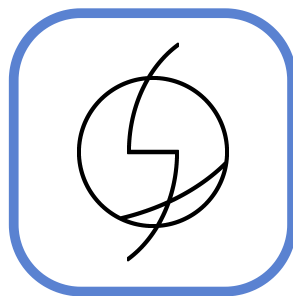
A course in language creation



Conlangs University

Phonology 1 — Assignment

Using the IPA



March 2020

Slorany, Tutor

Exercise

This is this week's assignment. It is an easy one, but one that will help you remember this week's write-up, especially the parts about the IPA.

Objectives

1. Recognise the symbols of the IPA
2. Recognise the **features** that go into building the IPA's consonants chart
3. Get used to typing the IPA (methods for this are available in the Phonology 1 document)
4. Do some research (wikipedia is enough for this!)
5. Prepare you for Phonology 2

Instructions

1. Create a document. This can be done in Excel, Photoshop, or even on paper. Anything, as long as you can export it to PDF or JPG/PNG.
2. Create an *efficient* consonant chart for the following sounds:
 - bilabial plosive
 - voiced nasal retroflex
 - unvoiced velar fricative
 - bilabial fricative
 - lateral approximant retroflex
 - palatal nasal
 - palatal fricatives
 - glottal stop
 - voiced post-alveolar affricate
 - bilabial click
 - voiced palatal affricate
 - labio-velar approximants
 - bilabial nasal
 - the english <r> sound
 - the sound at the end of "parking"
 - the first sound in "stock"
 - the french R
 - the european spanish <j>
 - the first sound in "xylophone"

Tips

Feeling lost? Here are just a few tips!

What is an "efficient" consonant chart?

A chart is efficient when it carries no unnecessary information.

For instance, you don't need to display an "alveolar" column or a "lateral approximant" row if you have no alveolar sounds to display, or no lateral approximants.

Where do I start?

I'd advise just starting with a simple chart with a few columns and a few rows, and filling it as you go. Trying to group the sounds in the list by similarity in Place and Manner of articulation before throwing them at the chart could help, too!



The following page(s) will contain the solved assignment, please proceed only if you have completed the assignment yourself and want to check your answers.



NOTE:

The table you will get with this exercise is **not** supposed to resemble any extant language. It is a collection of semi-random symbols and the sole goal is to help you practice reading and typing the International Phonetic Alphabet.

Solution

The following solution is minimally efficient:

↓ Manner / Place →	Labial	Alveolar	Post-alveolar	Retroflex	Palatal	Velar	Uvular	Glottal
Nasal	m			ɳ	ɲ	ŋ		
Plosive	p							ʔ
Affricate			ɖʒ		tʃ			
Fricative	ɸ	s z			ç ʝ	x	ʁ	
Approximant	ɱ w	ɹ		ɭ				
Click	ǀ							

NOTE:

Some columns don't have all of their rows filled. We can merge the places of articulation that are very close to each other in an attempt to save some space and make a smaller table, easier to read. This is possible because each symbol carries information about its *manner* and *place* of articulation.

NOTE 2:

Here, we follow the convention that unvoiced sounds come first and are on the left of a column, while voiced sounds are on the right.

Here, we group alveolar, post-alveolar and retroflex into a "near alveolar" (as they occur at, or close to, the alveolar ridge) column. This column could also be named "[coronal](#)". It is slightly more efficient, but it could be better.

↓ Manner / Place →	Labial	Near-alveolar	Palatal	Velar	Uvular	Glottal
Nasal	m	ɳ	ɲ	ŋ		
Plosive	p					ʔ
Affricate		ɖʒ	tʃ			
Fricative	ɸ	s z	ç ʝ	x	ʁ	
Approximant	ɱ w	ɹ ɭ				
Click	ǀ					

Let's group those three rightmost columns, as they barely have any symbols in them, and only two are in the same row. We'll put them under a "(Post-)velar" label, which indicates the sounds in it are articulated at the velum or further back in the mouth.

↓ Manner / Place →	Labial	Near-alveolar	Palatal	(Post-)velar
Nasal	m	ɲ	ɲ	ŋ
Plosive	p			ʔ
Affricate		ɖʒ	ʧʝ	
Fricative	ɸ	s z	ç ʝ	x ɣ
Approximant	ɰ w	ɹ ɻ		
Click	⦿			



Can something be done about those rows? The answer is "yes"!

We can notice that there is never a plosive where there is an affricate and, as such, we can slim down the rows by grouping those two together.

↓ Manner / Place →	Labial	Near-alveolar	Palatal	(Post-)velar
Nasal	m	ɲ	ɲ	ŋ
Plosive/Affricate	p	ɖʒ	ʧʝ	ʔ
Fricative	ɸ	s z	ç ʝ	x ɣ
Approximant	ɰ w	ɹ ɻ		
Click	⦿			



Variations

Accepted solutions included:

- χ, h or fi as the "spanish j";
- R, χ for the "french R";
- placing ɰ w in a "velar" column;
- including both (or either of) voiced and unvoiced variants of any sound that did not have a specified voicing.